

Screening Success

Great Ideas are nothing but decent ideas that have been presented really well. Dim the lights ladies and gentlemen...nine projectors in test!

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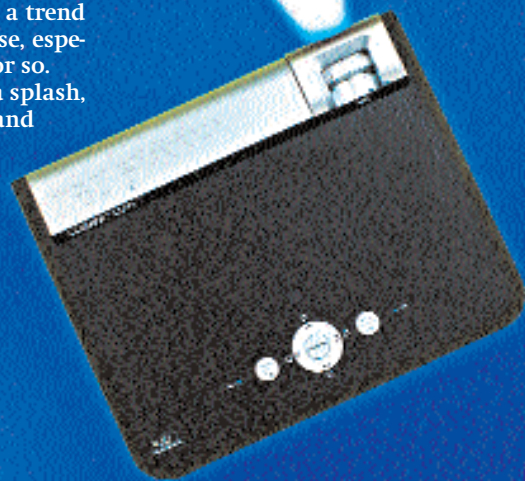
Be it a PowerPoint slide of the next big idea or a sales report, it's the presentation that matters. Because the devil really is in the details! How many times have you come across a really great idea falling short of appeal because of inefficient communication? And what else is a presentation if not an effort to psyche (for lack of a better word) others into your way of thinking?

And that's what a projector is—a communication tool for the discerning professional, which gets across the message like no words or laptops ever can. Gone are the days when boardrooms were impressed by presentations on a puny 15.4-inch screen. If you want to get your point across, you need

emphatic statements, strong convictions, and, of course, one of these test subjects!

Projectors these days aren't exclusive to the corporate realm, and their use in building a home entertainment system is a trend that is sharply on the rise, especially over the last year or so.

LCD TVs have made a splash, and so have the newer and bigger plasma screens.



These are typically viewed as entertainment projectors because of the superior resolution they provide; however, they don't cost as much as you'd think. With businesses using Flash animations and even 3D rendering software for presentations, a multimedia projector is well worth the little extra.

There will also be those users (albeit one in a thousand of our readers) who will want to, or be able to, afford to use a projector to play games. Yes, hooked up to a capable PC, most XGA projectors today are capable of very acceptable results. We tried playing a number of games on all the projectors, and a couple of our gaming freaks actually started creeping into the *Digit* Test Centre for some late-night action!

Gone are the days when a business-grade projector was just that, and totally unsuitable for multimedia purposes. Today's projectors are more suitable to a variety of tasks.

While a 103-inch screen may mean visual utopia, the prices of such screens are astronomical. Enter the projector... As you will see all throughout these tests, some of the projectors we received make for very suitable components for a full-fledged home entertainment system.

Most corporate users will feel that a costlier home-entertainment projector isn't necessary for presenting reports. With escalating costs, it isn't necessary to add one more, is it? Wrong—as with all technology, the binary of advancements and falling costs is strongly in place.

Most projectors available today are XGA (capable of a resolution of 1024x768).

